

LINGER

1. Passage anchor

> “It is the kind of book that **lingers in your mind**...”

Passage meaning

linger in your mind = remain in your thoughts or memory for a long time after the original experience

久久留在腦海中；揮之不去；一直令人記得

Here, the speaker means the book continues to occupy their thoughts even after they have finished reading it.

Practice

1. The final scene **lingered in my mind** for days.

最後一幕在我腦海中**久久揮之不去**。

2. Her words **lingered in his thoughts** long after the conversation ended.

對話結束很久後，她的話仍然**留在他的思緒中**。

Core meanings of LINGER

2. linger — stay somewhere longer than necessary

= remain in a place instead of leaving quickly

逗留；徘徊；留連

Examples

1. We **lingered** outside the café after dinner.

晚餐後我們在咖啡店外**逗留了一會兒**。

2. She **lingered** by the door before leaving.

她離開前在門口**停留了一下**。

This is the central literal sense.

3. linger around / linger behind

= remain nearby or stay after others have left

****在附近逗留；留下來****

Examples

1. A few students ****lingered behind**** after class.

下課後有幾個學生****留下來沒有馬上走****。

2. People continued to ****linger around**** the entrance.

人們仍然在入口附近****徘徊****。

Continue to exist

4. linger — continue to exist for longer than expected

= remain present even though it might have been expected to disappear

****持續存在；久久不散****

Examples

1. The tension ****lingered**** after the meeting.

會議結束後，緊張氣氛仍然****久久不散****。

2. Doubts ****lingered**** despite the explanation.

儘管已經解釋過，疑慮仍然****持續存在****。

Major figurative sense.

5. lingering effect / problem

= effect or problem that continues for some time

****持續的影響；揮之不去的問題****

Examples

1. The illness had ****lingering effects****.

那場病留下了****持續的影響****。

2. There were ****lingering concerns**** about safety.

人們對安全仍有****揮之不去的憂慮****。

Memory / thought

6. linger in the mind / memory

= remain memorable or continue to occupy someone's thoughts

留在腦海 / 記憶中；揮之不去

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. The image **lingered in her memory**.

那個畫面一直**留在她的記憶中**。

2. The question **lingered in my mind**.

那個問題一直**縈繞在我心頭**。

7. lingering memory

= memory that continues to remain vivid or emotionally present

久久不散的記憶；揮之不去的回憶

Examples

1. He carried a **lingering memory** of the place.

他一直保留著對那個地方**揮之不去的記憶**。

2. The experience left a **lingering memory**.

那次經歷留下了**久久不散的回憶**。

Smell / taste / sound

8. linger — remain perceptible

= continue to be noticeable through smell, taste, sound, atmosphere, etc.

殘留；久久不散

Examples

1. The smell of coffee **lingered** in the room.

咖啡香在房間裡**久久不散**。

2. The music seemed to ****linger**** after it ended.

音樂結束後彷彿仍在空氣中****迴盪****。

9. lingering smell / taste

= smell or taste that remains after the source is gone

****殘留的氣味 / 味道****

Examples

1. There was a ****lingering smell of smoke****.

空氣中有一股****殘留的煙味****。

2. The tea leaves a ****lingering sweetness****.

這種茶會留下****久久不散的甜味****。

Delay / reluctance to leave

10. linger — delay because you do not want to leave

= stay because you are reluctant to go or want to enjoy something longer

****留連；依依不捨地停留****

Examples

1. We ****lingered**** over dessert.

我們吃甜點時****慢慢享用，不急著離開****。

2. She ****lingered**** in the garden before going home.

她回家前在花園裡****留連了一會兒****。

11. linger over something

= spend more time than usual enjoying, considering, or examining something

****慢慢享用；細細品味；久久停留在.....上****

Examples

1. She ****lingered over her coffee****.

她**慢慢喝著咖啡**。

2. He **lingered over the final paragraph**.
他在最後一段上**細細停留閱讀**。

Illness / recovery

12. linger — continue for a long time

= illness, pain, weakness, or symptoms continue instead of disappearing quickly

拖延不癒；持續

Examples

1. The cough **lingered** for weeks.
咳嗽**持續了幾星期都沒好**。
2. The pain **lingered** after the injury.
受傷後疼痛一直**持續**。

13. lingering illness

= illness that continues for a long time

久病；纏綿不癒的疾病

Examples

1. He recovered slowly from a **lingering illness**.
他從一場**久病**中慢慢康復。
2. She had been weakened by a **lingering illness**.
她因一場**長期不癒的疾病**而身體虛弱。

Emotional atmosphere

14. lingering sadness / doubt / fear

= emotion that remains after the main event has passed

揮之不去的悲傷 / 疑慮 / 恐懼

Examples

1. A sense of **lingering sadness** remained.
一種**揮之不去的悲傷**仍然存在。
2. There was **lingering doubt** about the decision.
人們對那個決定仍有**持續的疑慮**。

Related forms

15. lingering

A. lasting longer than expected

持續的；久久不散的

1. There was a **lingering silence**.
現場有一陣**久久不散的沉默**。

B. remaining emotionally or mentally

揮之不去的

2. She had **lingering doubts**.
她仍有**揮之不去的疑慮**。

16. lingeringly

Rare.

= in a prolonged or lingering way
久久地；留連地

Low priority in modern everyday English.

High-value expressions

17. linger on

= continue to exist or remain noticeable

****繼續存在；久久不散****

Examples

1. The memory ****lingered on**** for years.
那段記憶多年來一直****揮之不去****。
2. The smell ****lingered on**** after the fire.
火災過後，那股氣味仍然****久久不散****。

18. linger in the air

= remain present physically or figuratively

****瀰漫在空氣中；揮之不去****

Examples

1. The smell of perfume ****lingered in the air****.
香水味仍然****瀰漫在空氣中****。
2. An awkward silence ****lingered in the air****.
一股尷尬的沉默氣氛仍然****揮之不去****。

19. linger over

= spend time slowly with something instead of moving on quickly

****慢慢享用；細味；久久停留於****

Examples

1. We ****lingered over breakfast****.
我們****慢慢吃早餐****，沒有急著離開。
2. Readers may ****linger over**** certain passages.
讀者可能會在某些段落上****多停留一會兒細讀****。

Key contrasts

20. linger vs stay

****stay****

= remain somewhere

****留下；停留****

****linger****

= stay longer than expected, often slowly or reluctantly

****逗留；留連****

Compare:

> We stayed for an hour.

> 我們待了一小時。

> We lingered after everyone else left.

> 大家離開後，我們仍****逗留了一會兒****。

21. linger vs remain

****remain****

= neutral/formal: continue to exist or stay

****仍然；保持****

****linger****

= often suggests something stays longer than expected and may be difficult to remove or forget

****久久不散；揮之不去****

Compare:

> The problem remains.

> 問題仍然存在。

> The feeling lingers.

> 那種感覺****久久不散****。

22. linger vs last

****last****

= continue for a period of time

****持續****

****linger****

= continue beyond the point where it might have been expected to disappear

****拖延；久久不散****

Compare:

> The meeting lasted two hours.

> 會議持續兩小時。

> The tension lingered afterwards.

> 會議後緊張氣氛仍****久久不散****。

23. linger vs dwell

****dwell on something****

= keep thinking or talking about something, often too much

****反覆想；耿耿於懷****

****linger****

= remain in the mind or stay somewhere

Compare:

> Don't dwell on the mistake.

> 不要一直想那個錯誤。

> The mistake lingered in his mind.

> 那個錯誤一直****留在他的腦海中****。

24. linger vs haunt

****haunt****

= repeatedly return to someone's mind in a disturbing or painful way

****縈繞不去；困擾****

****linger****

= simply remain in memory or thought; can be positive, neutral, or negative

****久久留在腦海****

A beautiful scene can ****linger**** in your mind, but would not normally ****haunt**** you.

Meaning map

The central concept of **linger** is:

remain longer than expected instead of disappearing or leaving quickly

From this develop:

Place

linger outside

→ **在外面逗留**

Social

linger after dinner

→ **餐後留連**

Passage

linger in your mind

→ **久久留在腦海**

Emotion

sadness lingers

→ **悲傷揮之不去**

Smell

smell lingers

→ **氣味久久不散**

Sound

music lingers

→ **餘音迴盪**

Illness

cough lingers

→ **咳嗽遲遲未癒**

The passage uses the **memory/thought** branch:

> book lingers in your mind

> → **書讀完後仍然一直留在你的思緒中**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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linger — stay in a place	比預期停留更久；逗留 / 徘徊
linger around/behind	在附近繼續逗留 / 留下來
linger — continue to exist	本應消失後仍持續存在；久久不散
lingering effect/problem	持續很久、未完全消失的影響 / 問題
linger in the mind/memory	長時間留在思想或記憶中；揮之不去
lingering memory	久久不散、仍清晰存在的回憶
linger — smell/taste/sound	氣味、味道、聲音等持續殘留
linger — reluctant to leave	因不想離開或想多享受一會而留連
linger over something	花較長時間慢慢享用、閱讀或思考某事
linger — illness/pain	病痛、症狀等遲遲不消失 / 持續
lingering illness	長時間不癒的疾病 / 久病
lingering sadness/doubt	事件過後仍揮之不去的悲傷 / 疑慮
lingering — adjective	持續不散、未消失的
linger on	繼續存在 / 久久不散
linger in the air	氣味、氣氛等仍瀰漫著 / 揮之不去

Passage recap

> “It is the kind of book that **lingers in your mind**...”

Here:

linger in your mind = **remain in your thoughts or memory long after the original experience has ended**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **久久留在腦海中**

* **一直縈繞在心頭**

* **揮之不去**

* contextually: **讀完後仍會一直想起**

Natural contextual translation:

這本書屬於那種讀完之後仍會久久留在你腦海中的作品。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****linger****

= ****to remain present for longer than expected instead of disappearing quickly****

****逗留；持續存在；久久不散****

The central metaphor is easy to carry across contexts:

> a person ****lingers**** after dinner

> → 人沒有馬上離開

> a smell ****lingers**** in the room

> → 氣味沒有馬上散去

> sadness ****lingers****

> → 悲傷沒有馬上消失

> a book ****lingers in your mind****

> → ****書的內容與感受讀完後仍然留在腦海****

That lingering effect is exactly what the speaker means in the passage.